

are related to calories, the additional amount recommended during pregnancy and lactation are based on additional calories. Thus, the additional amounts (mg) recommended during pregnancy is 0.2 mg thiamine, 0.2 mg riboflavin, and 2 mg niacin equivalents. The additional amount of pyridoxine recommended is 2.5 mg during pregnancy as well as lactation.

iv) Folate

During pregnancy there is considerable increase in the demand for folates, which are required for DNA synthesis in the rapidly growing tissue. The greatest significance of folic acid and its potential influence on pregnancy outcome is its role in preventing neural tube defects, such as **spina bifida**. Folic acid deficiency can lead to anencephaly. Recommended daily intake for adults is 100µg and for pregnant women 400µg. To reach this level, the consumption of green vegetables should be increased and additional folate supplements should be given even in pre pregnancy stage and throughout pregnancy.

v) Vitamin B 12

The recommended intake of vitamin B12 for adults is 2µg per day. During pregnancy, additional amount is required for haemopoiesis and liver storage for the foetus and subsequent secretion in milk. During the later half of pregnancy, the requirement of vitamin B12 increases to 3.0µg per day to provide for foetal storage of 50 - 100µg.

2.1.5 Dietary guidelines

Usually a diet containing 3 cups of milk or its equivalent, 2 servings of meat, fish, poultry, eggs, or a source of complete protein, a dark green yellow vegetables and generous serving of citrus fruits will provide a foundation for a nutritionally adequate diet. Between the 6th to 14th week of pregnancy 75% women suffer from nausea which inturn affect the appetite. The conception of small and frequent meals at regular intervals are helpful to many women. This pattern is also very helpful in the later part of pregnancy

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